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Rose

February 1944

Rose watched the sun break over the steep hills. She hadn't been able to sleep. She nodded off for an hour, then woke with a start, opening her eyes to see if it was daylight. The previous evening's visit to Reinhardt had set off a ticking time bomb inside her after he announced that *her cousin* would be arriving the following day.

Four months had passed since she'd seen André. During that time, the war had undergone a fundamental shift that she was just beginning to grasp. It was impossible to know what was really going on when she received such sparse information.

The headlines in the German papers announced that the *relentless bombing campaigns were terrorist acts inflicted by Britain and the United States on the citizens of Germany.* Hamburg had been targeted because the celebrated U-boats were manufactured there. Rose shuddered to think what fires the Allies planned to unleash on Berlin. At least, André would soon be here and safe.

A copper light fell over the spruces dotting the slopes. Rose wondered what life would now be like with André by her side. It was almost too good to believe. She imagined all the places they could go together to be alone—the forest, where they would walk along the birch and linden. It would be their refuge, the place they could meet and be themselves. Glashütte was too small. Their movements would be noticed and reported back to the Gestapo office. They couldn't stroll hand in hand as they had in Berlin. Here, they'd play the role of cousins. She'd have to carefully stick to that because she'd seen Reinhardt's temper flare in short bursts and feared what